BOOK *of* GIANTS

In English

INTRODUCTION

The Book of the Giants, although fragmented, complements the narrative found in 1 Enoch. Discovered among the Dead Sea Scrolls at Qumran, this text elaborates on the story of the Watchers and their giant offspring. The Giants, aware of the impending divine judgment, seek Enoch's intercession. The fragments of this book provide a deeper understanding of the mythological framework of the Enochic literature and highlight the themes of repentance and divine retribution.

THE BOOK OF GIANTS

The Book of Giants is an ancient Jewish apocryphal text that expands on the stories found in the Book of Enoch, particularly those concerning the fallen angels, known as the Watchers, and their offspring, the Nephilim. This work is part of the Enoch literature and provides additional details about the events leading up to the Great Flood, focusing on the giants born from the union of the Watchers and human women. The text survives in fragmentary form, primarily through the Dead Sea Scrolls discovered at Qumran, as well as some later Manichaean versions found in Central Asia. Through vivid dreams, divine messages, and the tragic fate of the giants, the text explores themes of sin, judgment, and redemption. Although the work survives only in fragments, its insights into the Enoch tradition and its depiction of early Jewish mythological themes make it an invaluable resource for understanding the broader context of ancient Jewish apocalyptic literature.

The Corruption of the Watchers

The Book of Giants begins by recounting the fall of the Watchers, the angels who descended to Earth and mated with human women, resulting in the birth of the Nephilim, or giants. These giants are depicted as beings of immense size and strength who cause great chaos and violence on the Earth. Their actions contribute significantly to the corruption and wickedness that ultimately lead to God's decision to cleanse the world with a flood.

Visions and Dreams of the Giants

A central theme in the Book of Giants is the series of ominous dreams and visions experienced by the giants, foretelling their impending doom. Two giants, often identified as Ohya and Mahway, receive these visions. In their dreams, they see symbolic representations of their destruction and the coming deluge. Disturbed by these premonitions, the giants seek out the prophet Enoch for interpretation and guidance.

Enoch's Intercession and Message

Enoch, known for his wisdom and ability to communicate with divine beings, plays a key role in the narrative. The giants approach him to understand their visions. Enoch interprets the dreams as divine warnings of the impending judgment due to their sins and the sins of their fathers, the Watchers. He admonishes the giants to repent, although it is clear that their fate is already sealed.

The Petition to Heaven

The Watchers, realizing the gravity of their situation and the severity of their impending punishment, petition Enoch to intercede on their behalf with God. They hope that Enoch's favored status might secure mercy for them. Enoch ascends to heaven to deliver their plea, but the response he receives confirms that the judgment against them is irreversible. This section highlights the themes of divine justice and the inescapability of the consequences of their transgressions.

The Fate of the Giants

The final sections of the Book of Giants detail the consequences of the giants' actions. As prophesied in their dreams and Enoch's interpretations, the giants face a cataclysmic end. The text describes their destruction, which serves as a prelude to the Great Flood that will cleanse the Earth of the corruption introduced by the Watchers and their offspring. This section underscores the themes of judgment, repentance, and the restoration of divine order.

Unreadable or missing portions of the text are signified by … within the text. The symbol […] signifies a phrase or portion thereof.

. . . hard . . . arrow . . . bow, he that . . . Sām said: "Blessed be . . . had [he ?] seen this, he would not have died." Then Shahmīzād said to Sām, his [son]: "All that Māhawai . . ., is spoilt ." Thereupon he said to . . . "We are . . . until . . . and . . . . . that are in the fiery hell . . . As my father, Virōgdād, was . . ." Shahmīzād said: "It is true what he says. He says one of thousands. For one of thousands . . . .". Sām thereupon began . . . Māhawai, too, in many places . . . until to that place he might escape and . . .

. . . Virōgdād . . . Hōbābīš robbed Ahr . . . of -naxtag, his wife. Thereupon the giants began to kill each other and [to abduct their wives]. The creatures, too, began to kill each other. Sām . . . before the sun, one hand in the air, the other . . . whatever he obtained, to his brother . . . . imprisoned . . . . . over Taxtag. To the angels . . . from heaven. Taxtag to . . .

Taxtag threw into the water. Finally . . . in his sleep Taxtag saw three signs, [one portending . . .], one woe and flight, and one . . . annihilation. Narīmān saw a gar[den full of] trees in rows. Two hundred . . . came out, the trees. . . .

. . . Enoch, the apostle, . . . [gave] a message to [the demons and their] children: To you . . . not peace. [The judgment on you is] that you shall be bound for the sins you have committed. You shall see the destruction of your children. ruling for a hundred and twenty [years] . . . . . wild ass, ibex . . . ram, goat , gazelle, . . . oryx, of each two hundred, a pair . . . the other wild beasts, birds, and animals and their wine [shall be] six thousand jugs . . . irritation of water . . . and their oil shall be . . .

. . . father . . . nuptials . . . until the completion of his . . . in fighting . . . . . and in the nest Ohya and Ahya . . . he said to his brother: "get up and . . . we will take what our father has ordered us to. The pledge we have given . . . battle." And the giants . . . together . . . "[Not the] . . . of the lion, but the . . . on his . . . [Not the] . . . of the rainbow, but the bow . . . firm. Not the sharpness of the blade, [but] the strength of the ox . Not the . . . eagle, but his wings. Not the . . . gold, but the brass that hammers it. Not the proud [ruler], but the diadem on his [head. Not] the splendid cypress, but the . . . of the mountain . . .

. . . Not he that engages in quarrels, but he that is true in his speech. Not the evil fruit, but the poison in it. [Not they that] are placed in the skies but the God [of all] worlds. Not the servant is proud, but [the lord] that is above him. Not one that is sent . . ., but the man that sent him". Thereupon Narīmān . . . said . . . . . And another place I saw those that were weeping for the ruin that had befallen them, and whose cries and laments rose up to heaven. And also I saw another place [where there were] tyrants and rulers . . . in great number, who had lived in sin and evil deeds, when . . .

. . . many . . . were killed, four hundred thousand Righteous . . . with fire, naphtha, and brimstone . . . And the angels veiled Enoch. Electae et auditrices . . . and ravished them. They chose beautiful [women], and demanded . . . them in marriage. Sordid . . . . . all . . . carried off . . . severally they were subjected to tasks and services. And they . . . from each city . . . and were, ordered to serve the . . . The Mesenians [were directed] to prepare, the Khūzians to sweep [and] water, the Persians to . . .

[On the Five Elements]

. . . slaying . . . righteous . . . good deeds . . . . elements. The crown, the diadem, [the garland, and] the garment . The seven demons. Like a blacksmith [who] binds and looses . . . . who from the seeds of . . . . and serves the king . . . . . offends . . . when weeping . . . with mercy . . . hand . . . . . the Pious gave . . . ? . . . presents. Some buried the idols. The Jews did good and evil. Some make their god half demon, half god . . . killing . . . the seven demons . . . eye . . .

. . . various colours that by . . . and bile. If. . . . from the five elements. As if a means not to die, they fill themselves with food and drink. Their garment is . . . this corpse . . . and not firm . . . Its ground is not firm . . . Like . . . . . imprisoned [in this corpse], in bones, nerves, [flesh], veins, and skin, and entered herself [= Āz] into it. Then he cries out, over sun and moon, the Just God's two flames . . . ? . . ., over the elements, the trees and the animals. But God [Zrwān ?], in each epoch, sends apostles: Šīt[īl, Zarathushtra,] Buddha, Christ, . . .

. . . evil-intentioned . . . from where . . . he came. The Misguided recognize the five elements, [the five kinds of] trees, the five animals.

. . . On the Hearers

. . . we receive . . . from Mani, the Lord, . . . the Five Commandments to . . . the Three Seals . . . . . living . . . profession . . . and wisdom . . . moon. Rest from the power . . . own. And keep measured the mixture . . . trees and wells, in two . . . water, and fruit, milk, . . . he should not offend his brother. The wise [Hearer] who like unto juniper [leaves . . .

. . . much profit. Like a farmer . . . who sows seed . . in many . . . The Hearer who . . . knowledge, is like unto a man that threw frōšag [into] milk. It became hard, not . . . The part that ruin . . . at first heavy. Like . . . first . . . is honoured . . . might shine . . . six days. The Hearer who gives alms , is like unto a poor man that presents his daughter to the king; he reaches great honour. In the body of the Elect the alms is purified in the same manner as a . . . that by fire and wind . . . beautiful clothes on a clean body . . . turn . . .

. . . witness . . . fruit . . . . . tree . . . like firewood . . . like a grain . . . radiance. The Hearer in [the world ?], the alms within the Church, are like unto a ship [on the sea] : the towing-line in the hand of [the tower] on shore, the sailor is [on board the ship]. The sea is the world, the ship is [the . . ., the . . . is the ?al]ms, the tower is [the . . . ?], the towing-line is the Wisdom. . . . . The Hearer . . . is like unto the branch

of a fruitless [tree] . . . fruitless . . . and the Hearers . . . fruit that . . . pious deeds. [The Elect,] the Hearer, and Vahman, are like unto three brothers to whom some [possessions] were left by their father: a piece of land, . . ., seed. They became partners . . . they reap and . . . The Hearer . . . like . . .

. . . an image of the king, cast of gold . . . . . the king gave presents. The Hearer that copies a book, is like unto a sick man that gave his . . . to a . . . man. The Hearer that gives [his] daughter to the church, is like . . . pledge, who gave his son to . . . learn . . . to . . . father, pledge . . . . . Hearer. Again, the Hearer . . . is like . . . . stumble . . . is purified. To . . . the soul from the Church, is like unto the wife of the soldier who . . . infantrist, one shoe . . . who, however, with a denarius . . . was. The wind tore out one . . . he was abashed . . . from the ground . . . ground . . .

. . . . . sent . . . The Hearer that makes one . . ., is like unto [a compassionate mother] who had seven sons . . . the enemy [killed] all . . . The Hearer that . . . piety . . . . . a well. One [on the shore of] the sea, one in the boat. [He that is on] shore, tows him that is [in the boat]. He that is in the boat. . . . sea. Upwards to . . . like . . ? . . like a pearl . . . diadem . . .

. . . Church. Like unto a man that . . . fruit and flowers . . . then they praise . . . fruitful tree . . . . . [Like unto a man] that bought a piece of land. [On that] piece of land [there was] a well, [and in that well a bag] full of drachmas . . . the king was filled with wonder . . . share . . . pledge . . .

. . . numerous . . . Hearer. At . . . like unto a garment . . . like . . . to the master . . . like . . . and a blacksmith. The goldsmith . . . to honour, the blacksmith to . . . one to . . .

. . . fire was going to come out. And [I saw] that the sun was at the point of rising, and that [his ?] centre without increasing above was going to start rolling. Then came a voice from the air above. Calling me, it spoke thus: "Oh son of Virōgdād, your affairs are lamentable . More than this you shall [not] see. Do not die now prematurely, but turn quickly back from here." And again, besides this , I heard the voice of Enoch, the apostle, from the south, without, however, seeing him at all. Speaking my name very lovingly, he called. And downwards from . . . then

. . . " . . for the closed door of the sun will open, the sun's light and heat will descend and set your wings alight. You will burn and die," said he. Having heard these words, I beat my wings and quickly flew down from the air. I looked back: Dawn had . . . ., with the light of the sun it had come to rise over the Kögmän mountains. And again a voice came from above. Bringing the command of Enoch, the apostle, it said: "I call you, Virōgdād, . . . I know . . . his direction . . . you . . . you . . . Now quickly . . . people . . . also . . .

. . . I shall see. Thereupon now S[āhm, the giant] was [very] angry, and laid hands on M[āhawai, the giant], with the intention: I shall . . . and kill [you]. Then . . . the other g[iants . . .

. . . do not be afraid, for . . . [Sā]hm, the giant, will want to [kill] you, but I shall not let him . . . I myself shall damage . . . Thereupon Māhawai, the g[iant], . . . was satisfied . . .

. . . outside . . . and . . . left . . . . read the dream we have seen. Thereupon Enoch thus . . . . and the trees that came out, those are the Egrēgoroi , and the giants that came out of the women. And . . . . . over . . . pulled out . . . over . . .

. . . [when] they saw the apostle, . . . before the apostle . . . those demons that were [timid], were very, very glad at seeing the apostle. All of them assembled before him. Also, of those that were tyrants and criminals, they were [worried] and much afraid. Then . . .

. . . not to . . . Thereupon those powerful demons spoke thus to the pious apostle : If . . . . by us any sin [will] not [be committed ?], my lord, why ? . . . . you have . . . and weighty injunction . . .

. . . poverty . . . [those who] harassed the happiness of the Righteous, on that account they shall fall into eternal ruin and distress, into that Fire, the mother of all conflagrations and the foundation of all ruined tyrants. And when these sinful misbegotten sons of ruin in those crevices and . . . .

. . . you have not been better. In error you thought you would this false power eternally. You . . . all this iniquity . . .

. . . you that call to us with the voice of falsehood. Neither did we reveal ourselves on your account, so that you could see us, nor thus . . . . ourselves through the praise and greatness that to us . . . -given to you . . ., but . . .

. . . sinners . . . . . is visible, where out of this fire your soul will be prepared to eternal ruin . And as for you, sinful misbegotten sons of the Wrathful Self, confounders of the true words of that Holy One, disturbers of the actions of Good Deed, aggressors upon Piety, . . . -ers of the Living. . . ., who their . . .

. . . and on brilliant wings they shall fly and soar further outside and above that Fire, and shall gaze into its depth and height. And those Righteous that will stand around it, outside and above, they themselves shall have power over that Great Fire, and over everything in it. . . . . blaze . . . . souls that . . .

. . . they are purer and stronger [than the] Great Fire of Ruin that sets the worlds ablaze. They shall stand around it, outside and above, and splendour shall shine over them. Further outside and above it they shall fly after those souls that may try to escape from the Fire. And that . . . .

. . . pronouncement . . . . "The four angels with the two hundred [demons . . . ".

. . . they took and imprisoned all the helpers that were in the heavens. And the angels themselves descended from the heaven to the earth. And the two hundred demons saw those angels, they were much afraid and worried. They assumed the shape of men and hid themselves. Thereupon the angels forcibly removed the men from the demons, laid them aside, and put watchers over them . . . . the giants . . . . were sons . . . with each other in bodily union . . . . with each other self- . . . . and the . . . . that had been born to them, they forcibly removed them from the demons. And they led one half of them eastwards, and the other half westwards, on the skirts of four huge mountains, towards the foot of the Sumeru mountain, into thirty-two towns which the Living Spirit had prepared for them in the beginning. And one calls Aryān-waižan. And those men are . . . . in the first arts and crafts. . . . . they made . . . the angels . . . and to the demons . . . they went to fight. And those two hundred demons fought a hard battle with the [four angels], until [the angels used] fire, naphtha, and brimstone . . . .

Excerpts

And again Šanšai asked the Light Apostle: this world where mankind lives, why does one call it birth-death .

. . . and what they had seen in the heavens among the gods, and also what they had seen in hell, their native land, and furthermore what they had seen on earth,—all that they began to teach to the men. To Šahmīzād two sons were borne by . . . . One of them he named "Ohya"; in Sogdian he is called "Sāhm, the giant". And again a second son [was born] to him. He named him "Ahya"; its Sogdian is "Pāt-Sāhm". As for the remaining giants, they were born to the other demons and Yakṣas. Completed: "The Coming of the two hundred Demons".

. . . . manliness, in powerful tyranny, he shall not die". The giant Sāhm and his brother will live eternally. For in the whole world in power and strength, and in . . . . [they have no equal].

Quotations and Allusions

. . . . and in the coming of the two hundred demons there are two paths: the hurting speech, and the hard labour; these to hell.

. . . before . . . they were. And all the . . . fulfilled their tasks lawfully. Now, they became excited and irritated for the following reason: namely, the two hundred demons came down to the sphere from the high heaven, and the . . . .

. . . in the world they became excited and irritated. For their life-lines and the connections of their Pneumatic Veins are joined to sphere. Completed: the exposition of the three worlds. Here begins: the coming of Jesus and [his bringing] the religion to Adam and Šitil. . . . you should care and . . .

Earthquake and malice happened in the watchpost of the Great King of Honour, namely the Egrēgoroi who arose at the time when they were . . . . and there descended those who were sent to confound them.

Now attend and behold how the Great King of Honour who is ἔννοια, is in the third heaven. He is . . . with the wrath . . . and a rebellion . . ., when malice and wrath arose in his camp, namely the Egrēgoroi of Heaven who in his watch-district descended to the earth. They did all deeds of malice. They revealed the arts in the world, and the mysteries of heaven to the men. Rebellion and ruin came about on the earth . . .

And the story about the Great Fire: like unto the Fire, with powerful wrath, swallows this world and enjoys it; like unto this fire that is in the body, swallows the exterior fire that is in fruit and food, and enjoys it. Again, like unto two brothers who found a treasure, and a pursuer lacerated each other, and they died; like unto Ohya, Lewyātīn , and Raphael lacerated each other, and they vanished; like unto a lion cub, a calf in a wood , and a fox lacerated each other, [and they vanished, or: died]. Thus [the Great Fire swallows, etc.] both of the fires. . . .

On account of the malice and rebellion that had arisen in the watch-post of the Great King of Honour, namely the Egrēgoroi who from the heavens had descended to the earth,—on their

account the four angels received their orders: they bound the Egrēgoroi with eternal fetters in the prison of the Dark, their sons were destroyed upon the earth.

The Righteous who were burnt in the fire, they endured. This multitude that were wiped out, four thousand . . . . Enoch also, the Sage, the transgressors being . . .

. . . evil. 400,000 Righteous . . . . the years of Enoch . . .

Before the Egrēgoroi rebelled and descended from heaven, a prison had been built for them in the depth of the earth beneath the mountains. Before the sons of the giants were born who knew not Righteousness and Piety among themselves, thirty-six towns had been prepared and erected, so that the sons of the giants should live in them, they that come to beget . . . . who live a thousand years.

. . . mirror . . . image. . . . distributed. The men . . . and Enoch was veiled . They took . . . Afterwards, with donkey-goads . . . . slaves, and waterless trees . Then . . . and imprisoned the demons. And of them . . . . seven and twelve.

. . . three thousand two hundred and eighty- . . . the beginning of King Vištāsp. . . . . in the palace he flamed forth . And at night . . ., then to the broken gate . . . men . . . physicians, merchants, farmers, . . . at sea. ? . . . armoured he came out . . .

Appendix

. . . gifts. A peaceful sovereign [was] King Vištāsp, [in Aryā]n-Waižan ; Wahman and Zarēl . . . . The sovereign's queen, Khudōs, received the Faith, the prince . . . They have secured the hall, and quietude for ever and ever . . .

. . . because . . . the House of the Gods, eternal joy, and good . . ? . . For so it is said: at that time . . . Yima was . . . in the world. And at the time of the new moon . . . . the blessed denizens of the world . . . all assembled . . . all . . .

. . . they offered five garlands in homage. And Yima accepted those garlands . . . And those . . . that . . . . and great kingship . . . was his. And on . . . them . . . . And acclamations . . . And from that pious . . . he placed the garlands on his head . . . the denizens of the world . . .